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Babur Leaves Khujand

Earlier, Babur and his hordes had moved twice from Khujand. Once for Andijān and then for Samarkand. But during both times, Babur returned without any success. The place was very poor, and it was impossible to sustain the living of 300 men for long. Babur had realized that no ambition would be fulfilled by being stuck at Khujand.

Babur and his party wanted to return to Samarkand desperately.

To realize this desire, Babur sent people to confer with Muhammad Husayn Kurkan Dughlat in Aūrā-tīpā, seeking a loan to facilitate the winter stay in *Pashghar* till it became practical to move on to Samarkand. Luckily, Husayn agreed, and Babur rode to Pashaghar from Khujand along with his men.

They were just on the way and had made it only till Zamin when Babur contracted a very high fever. But nothing could have been done, and they had to rush on the mountain road until they reached Rabat-i-Khwaja. It was the headquarter of Shavdar Tuman's darogah. Babur hoped to take refuge in the fort using ladders, keeping the refuge a secret from the darogah. But as they reached the fort by dawn, the darogah's men were highly active. Thus, rendered helpless, Babur and his men had to march directly to Pashaghar.

Fighting high fever, Babur had ridden uninterrupted for around seventy miles and finally, reached his destination.

It had been only a few days at Pashaghar, and they appointed Ibrahim Saru Wais Laghari, Sherim Taghai, and other brave begs to make an expedition to get control of the Yar-Yilaq forts. Babur was back to business.

Yar-Yilaq was owned by Sayyid Yusug Beg. After having remained in Samarkand during the exodus period of Babur, he gained a lot of favour from Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā. The fort was being taken care of by Yusuf's younger brother's son Ahmad-i-Yusuf, the governor of Sialkot.